Butia Palm

Butia capitata

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 2 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 10–25 ft (sources range 10–15 ft to 20–35 ft). **Open:** Mature height range varies; no tight three-source agreement. × 10–15 ft. Confirmed by multiple sources.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. One of the hardiest feather palms.
Hardy Zones 8–11 (sources vary 8a–11). Common in southern Georgia and north Florida. Cold hardy to approximately 10–15ºF once established. Performs well in Atlanta with good drainage. Restart pass (2026-10-13): Regional sources confirm Zone 8a hardiness with protection. Existing notes stand.
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Low to medium once established. Drought tolerant. Prefers well-drained soil.
Soil: Well-drained. Adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Prefers moist but not wet.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in well-drained soil. Water regularly until established, then drought tolerant. Protect young plants from extreme cold. Allow space for crown spread. Minimal pruning (remove old fronds if desired).
Soil prep: Well-drained. Adaptable (clay, loam, sand). Prefers moist but not wet.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to southern South America (grasslands, dry woodlands). Introduced to U.S. Southeast as ornamental. Fruits used for jelly.
Form / habit: Evergreen palm. Solitary trunk. Arching blue-green to gray-green pinnate leaves. Slow growth.
Foliage: None (evergreen).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Trunk patterned with persistent leaf bases. Stout.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally low maintenance. Disease may be an issue in some coastal Florida locations. No serious problems uniquely stated for Zone 8a. **Open:** Specific Atlanta pest/disease data is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Arching gray-green to blue-green fronds. - Edible orange-yellow fruit (used for jelly). - One of the hardiest pinnate palms. - Slow growing. - RHS Award of Garden Merit.